

Data Staged

Sub-techniques (2)



Adversaries may stage collected data in a central location or directory prior to Exfiltration. Data may be kept in separate files or combined into one file through techniques such as [Archive Collected Data](#). Interactive command shells may be used, and common functionality within [cmd](#) and [bash](#) may be used to copy data into a staging location.^[1]

In cloud environments, adversaries may stage data within a particular instance or virtual machine before exfiltration. An adversary may [Create Cloud Instance](#) and stage data in that instance.^[2]

Adversaries may choose to stage data from a victim network in a centralized location prior to Exfiltration to minimize the number of connections made to their C2 server and better evade detection.

ID: T1074

Sub-techniques: [T1074.001](#), [T1074.002](#)

- ① **Tactic:** [Collection](#)
- ① **Platforms:** ESXi, IaaS, Linux, Windows, macOS

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[Version Permalink](#)

Procedure Examples

ID	Name	Description
G1032	INC Ransom	INC Ransom has staged data on compromised hosts prior to exfiltration. ^{[3][4]}
S1020	Kevin	Kevin can create directories to store logs and other collected data. ^[5]
S0641	Kobalos	Kobalos can write captured SSH connection credentials to a file under the <code>/var/run</code> directory with a <code>.pid</code> extension for exfiltration. ^[6]
S1076	QUIETCANARY	QUIETCANARY has the ability to stage data prior to exfiltration. ^[7]
G1015	Scattered Spider	Scattered Spider stages data in a centralized database prior to exfiltration. ^[8]
S1019	Shark	Shark has stored information in folders named <code>u1</code> and <code>u2</code> prior to exfiltration. ^[9]
G1055	VOID MANTICORE	VOID MANTICORE has staged compressed files in specified locations prior to exfiltration over C2. ^[10]
G1017	Volt Typhoon	Volt Typhoon has staged collected data in password-protected archives. ^[11]
G0102	Wizard Spider	Wizard Spider has collected and staged credentials and network enumeration information, using the <code>networkdll</code> and <code>psfin</code> TrickBot modules. ^[12]

Mitigations

This type of attack technique cannot be easily mitigated with preventive controls since it is based on the abuse of system features.

Detection Strategy

ID	Name	Analytic ID	Analytic Description
DET0014	Detection of Data Staging Prior to Exfiltration	AN0040	Detects staging of sensitive files into temporary or public directories, compression with 7zip/WinRAR, or batch copy prior to exfiltration.
		AN0041	Detects script or user activity copying files to a central temp or /mnt directory followed by archive/compression utilities.
		AN0042	Detects files collected into user temp or shared directories followed by compression with ditto, zip, or custom scripts.
		AN0043	Detects virtual disk expansion or file copy operations to cloud buckets or mounted volumes from isolated instances.
		AN0044	Detects snapshots or data stored in VMFS volumes from root CLI or remote agents.

References

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3. [Team Huntress. \(2023, August 11\). Investigating New INC Ransom Group Activity. Retrieved June 5, 2024.](#)

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6. [M.Leveille, M., Sanmillan, I. \(2021, January\). A WILD KOBALOS APPEARS Tricky Linux malware goes after HPCs. Retrieved August 24, 2021.](#)

7. [Hawley, S. et al. \(2023, February 2\). Turla: A Galaxy of Opportunity. Retrieved May 15, 2023.](#)

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9. [ClearSky Cyber Security. \(2021, August\). New Iranian Espionage Campaign By “Siamesekitten” - Lyceum. Retrieved June 6, 2022.](#)

10. [FBI. \(2026, March 20\). FBI Flash: FLASH-20260320-001:Government of Iran Cyber Actors Deploy Telegram C2 to Push Malware to Identified Targets. Retrieved April 20, 2026.](#)

11. [Microsoft Threat Intelligence. \(2023, May 24\). Volt Typhoon targets US critical infrastructure with living-off-the-land techniques. Retrieved July 27, 2023.](#)

12. [John, E. and Carvey, H. \(2019, May 30\). Unraveling the Spiderweb: Timelining ATT&CK Artifacts Used by GRIM SPIDER. Retrieved May 12, 2020.](#)